

Poor seasonal rainfall again hits southern pastoral areas

Key Messages

- October to December 2018 seasonal rainfall has been below-average and erratic in southern pastoral areas except in and around Shabelle and Nogob. The start of the *Deyr/Hageya season* was delayed and long dry spells have been reported. Rangeland conditions have remained mixed, with many southern pastoral areas still seeing improvements owing in part to residual soil moisture, while parts of southwestern Somali and southern Oromia are experiencing below-average rangeland regeneration.
- Most 2018 *Meher* crops across the country are at the harvest stage, if not harvested yet, with some still at the maturity stage. However, the development of unseasonal rainfall in October and November, particularly in parts of Tigray, Amhara, SNNPR, and western and central Oromia, has hindered harvest and storage activities, impacting harvest yields in affected areas.
- Intermittent clashes among communities in Oromia, SNNPR, Somali, Benishangul Gumuz, Amhara, and Tigray regions have continued as more people become displaced by violence. The violence is also in many instances keeping households from their livelihoods and restricting humanitarian access. According to a November UN-OCHA humanitarian bulletin, an estimated 240,000 people from Benishangul Gumuz region have been displaced due to violence that started in late September.
- Much of Ethiopia is expected to remain in Minimal (IPC Phase 1) through the first half of 2019. However, southern pastoral areas that continue to recover from previous drought and northern pastoral Afar will remain in Crisis (IPC Phase 3). Localized agricultural areas that saw poor 2018 rainfall will also experience Stressed (IPC Phase 2) and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes. Additionally, conflict-affected woredas, particularly those that have seen associated levels of displacement, will also likely remain in Crisis (IPC Phase 3).

* FEWS NET's classifications are IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. As of IPC 3.0, the IPC no longer assesses the impact of food assistance on classification and thus no longer maps the (!). However, FEWS NET continues to produce food security maps inclusive of the (!) as well as maps compatible with IPC 3.0/3.1, which include the mapping of food security assistance bags. FEWS NET and the IPC use different methods to estimate the total Population in Need of humanitarian food assistance and assess the risk of Famine. Learn more at www.fews.net/about.

Key Message Update

This Key Message Update provides a high-level analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography. Learn more [here](#).